

# 9router: A Free Local Proxy That Routes Around AI Rate Limits and Cuts Token Costs

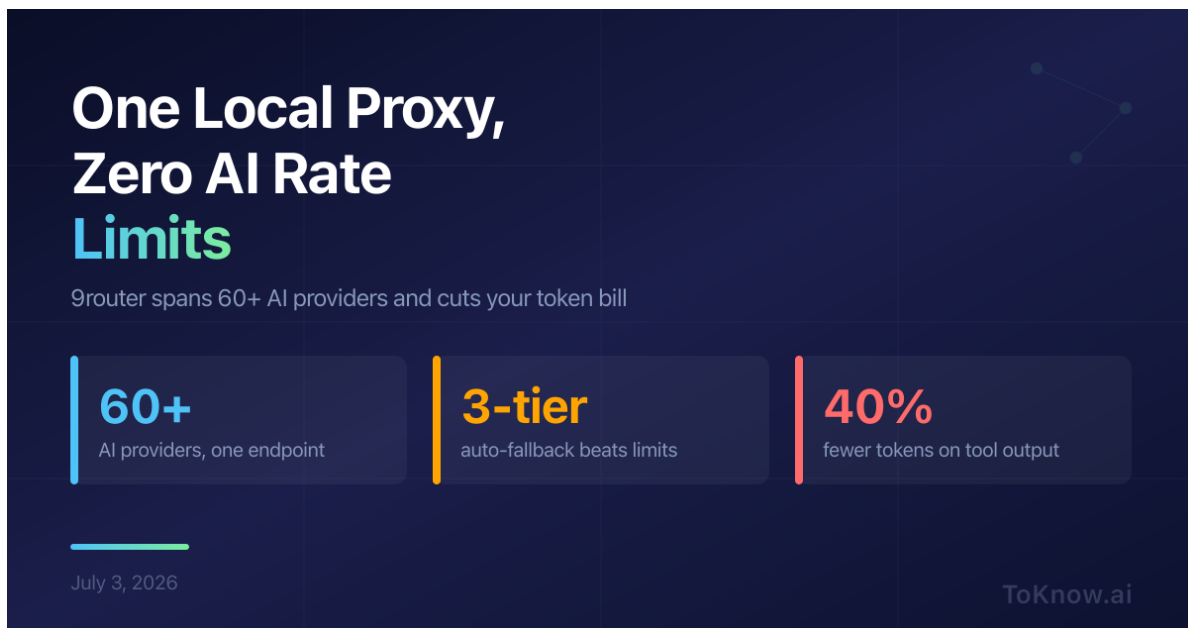
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The graphic features a dark blue background with a network diagram of three nodes in the top right. The main text 'One Local Proxy, Zero AI Rate Limits' is in white and green. Below it, a subtitle states '9router spans 60+ AI providers and cuts your token bill'. Three key features are highlighted in colored boxes: '60+' (blue) for 'AI providers, one endpoint', '3-tier' (yellow) for 'auto-fallback beats limits', and '40%' (red) for 'fewer tokens on tool output'. The date 'July 3, 2026' and the 'ToKnow.ai' logo are at the bottom.

**One Local Proxy,  
Zero AI Rate  
Limits**

9router spans 60+ AI providers and cuts your token bill

- 60+**  
AI providers, one endpoint
- 3-tier**  
auto-fallback beats limits
- 40%**  
fewer tokens on tool output

July 3, 2026 ToKnow.ai

[9router](#) is a free, MIT-licensed proxy that runs on your own machine and keeps a coding session alive when a provider cuts you off. One npm command opens an endpoint at `localhost:20128` that speaks the standard OpenAI format, so Claude Code, Codex, Cursor, or Cline can talk to it unchanged. Behind it, requests fan out across the 60-plus providers it lists in a three-tier fallback: your paid subscription first, then cheap options like GLM and MiniMax, then free

tiers like Kiro and OpenCode. When a quota runs dry it switches instead of failing, so a run that would stall at 2am keeps going for free.

It also trims tokens on the way through. A built-in feature called RTK, ported from the Rust “[Rust Token Killer](#)” project, compresses tool output like `git diff` and `grep` before it reaches the model, which 9router says cuts 20 to 40% of a request’s input tokens without changing the answer. A separate caveman mode shortens replies by up to 65%. For a solo developer who cannot absorb \$20 to \$50 a month per provider, that means fewer rate-limit walls and a smaller bill.

The convenience has two catches. Routing a paid subscription’s quota through another tool sits in a terms-of-service gray zone, and 9router’s optional bridge that intercepts GitHub Copilot, Antigravity, and Kiro traffic pushes that further; the project says to mind each tool’s policy. A local proxy that holds your keys and sees every prompt is a trust decision, and although the repo is MIT-licensed, its core app ships as a private package you cannot fully audit.

Read More: [where 9router fits among six token-cutting tools](#).

Sources:

- [9router](#)
- [9router source and README \(decolua/9router\)](#)
- [RTK, the Rust Token Killer that 9router ports for compression](#)
- [CLIPProxyAPI, the Go router that inspired the JavaScript port](#)

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